

# Penile Traction Therapy

Patient Information · A device you wear that gently stretches the penis

WARWIKI

Penile traction therapy uses a device that gives the penis a **gentle, steady stretch** each day. It is used mainly for **Peyronie's disease**, to lessen the curve and help keep length. It is also used after prostate surgery and before or after a penile implant. It does not need surgery, but it only works with **regular use over months**.

## How It Works

A steady, gentle pull helps the tissue and the scar (plaque) slowly **reshape**. This can lessen the curve and help keep length. The effect is small and slow. It is often used together with other Peyronie's treatments, such as injections.

## What to Expect

- You wear the device for a **set time each day**. The time depends on the device: newer ones are worn about **30–60 minutes** a day, and older ones for several hours.
- Studies used it for about **3 to 6 months**. In one study, men who kept using it from month 3 to month 6 gained a little more length.
- Studies are small and short. Results vary from man to man, and results past about 9 months are not known.
- Insurance often does not pay for it. Ask about the cost.

## Learn the Terms

### Traction therapy

Using a device to gently stretch the penis over time.

### Peyronie's disease

Scar tissue that bends the penis. It is the main reason for traction.

### Plaque

The patch of scar tissue that the stretch helps reshape.

### Penile rehabilitation

Keeping the penis healthy and its length, for example after surgery.

### Active or stable phase

Whether the Peyronie's curve is still changing or has settled.

**Does it really work?** It can give a **modest** improvement, but only if you use it every day for months. In studies, the curve improved by about 7–15 degrees on average, and some men gained about 1–2 cm of stretched length. It will not fully straighten a severe curve on its own.

## Using It Safely

- 1 Follow your device's **wear time and tension** instructions exactly. Do not over-tighten.
- 2 Use it on a soft penis. Stop the session if you feel **numbness or pain**, or see a color change.
- 3 Increase the tension slowly as your device's instructions say.
- 4 Keep the device clean.
- 5 Check with your team first if you had penile, scrotal or pelvic surgery in the last 6 weeks, or have sores, a skin infection, or ongoing pain in the penis or scrotum.

## Good to Know

- Mild redness, discomfort or brief numbness of the head of the penis can happen. These usually go away within minutes of taking it off.
- It is private and done at home.
- Be patient. Judge results over months, not days.
- Ask your team which device and schedule they suggest.

### Call the office that is treating you if you have:

- Pain, numbness, sores or skin color changes that do not go away
- A curve that is getting worse, new lumps, or weaker erections

### Go to an emergency department if:

- The penis stays numb, cold, pale or blue after you take the device off
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

### Three Things to Remember

1. Traction gently stretches the penis to lessen a Peyronie's curve and help keep length.
2. It only works with daily use over months, and the gains are modest.
3. Never over-tighten it. Stop if you feel numbness or pain.